



March 6th 2017 County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vxqbBKc_vS8
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 6, 2017

Prepared by: Expert Civic Analyst

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the Delaware County Commissioners meeting at 9:01 AM on Monday, March 6, 2017, with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:** Commissioners present included Mr. Erwin, Mr. Henry, and Mr. King. (Note: Presiding officer explicitly conducting roll calls via board members Mr. Erwin, Mr. Henry, and Mr. King).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Approved the minutes for the regular meeting on February 21, 2017, and the special meeting on February 27, 2017.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:57 Table of Business: Seizure of Funds Ordinance Withdrawal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal counsel (John) / Requested by the Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Counsel explained that he drafted an ordinance regarding a fund for sheriff seizure activities after conferring with the State Board of Accounts. However, state officials clarified that transferring money from the general fund into a specific fund is strictly the legal prerogative of the County Council, not the Commissioners. Consequently, the Commissioners moved to remove the item from the table and withdraw it so it can be handled by the Council.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Removed from table and withdrawn. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:02:32 Table of Business: Bids for Fuel, Asphalt Mix, Liquid Asphalt, and Crusher Stone**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual routine bidding process for highway materials. A motion was made and seconded to accept all bids.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Accepted annually. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:03:53 Presentation: Hope Redemption Center Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout, Delaware County Economic Development.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Bookout provided an update on a meeting held with the Hope Redemption Center and the County Sheriff. The organization is currently working to acquire property and collaborate with the Sheriff's Department to provide treatment access for individuals.
- **00:04:33 Presentation: Government-Fixed Assets Services Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Nielsen, Government Fixed Asset Services.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Nielsen presented findings regarding the county's capital and fixed assets, noting that the county lacks a comprehensive, auditable fixed asset record (estimating roughly \$400 million in capital assets, predominantly in roads and bridges managed by Angie at the highway department). Without this tracking, the State Board of Accounts cannot issue a clean/unqualified audit opinion. Nielsen proposed a \$22,500 contract to inventory, value, and establish auditable records over a couple of months, utilizing Purdue LTAP worksheets for infrastructure.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Held over/abled for further review next month.
- **00:18:14 Ordinance No. 2017-04: Vacation of Melissa Avenue (Alleyway/Street Vacation)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Angie (Highway Department) and Martin.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of two proposed vacations. An alleyway between lots 2 and 3 (owned by Mr. Carter) was recommended for approval. For the area south of lot 4 utilized by the Cowan Lions Club for parking and entry, staff

recommended a collaborative approach: the entire 60-foot right-of-way will be vacated to property owner Fred Carter, who will simultaneously execute a deed transferring the southern 30 feet directly to the Cowan Lions Club to protect their property and access. A representative from the Lions Club confirmed agreement with this arrangement.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with the condition that Mr. Carter records the vacation and immediately executes a deed for the south half to the Lions Club.
Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:23:59 Resolution No. 2017-C-09: Assigning Tax Sales Certificate to a Nonprofit (400 South Ohio)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Janet Kessler, Tax Sales Deputy / Brad Bookout, Economic Development.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution identifying a tax sale property at 400 South Ohio to be assigned to a nonprofit corporation. An interested party has expressed interest in acquiring it via an ECI Regional Planning District RFP. A public hearing is scheduled for April 3rd.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 2017-C-09 adopted by Voice Vote.
- **00:25:13 Resolution No. 2017-010: Assigning Tax Sales Certificates to a Nonprofit (209 North Penn and 1214 North Penn)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Janet Kessler, Tax Sales Deputy.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution identifying two delinquent tax sale properties (209 North Penn and 1214 North Penn) to be assigned to an interested nonprofit church. A public hearing is set for April 17th.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Voice Vote.
- **00:26:11 Department Head Report: EMS Write-Offs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Department Representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented patient billing write-offs for January 2017 (\$383,924.44) and February 2017 (\$333,355.12). Additionally, the department noted that contracts with their billing and collections companies are reaching their end, and renegotiations are underway.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved January and February write-offs by Voice Vote.
- **00:27:21 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of claims totaling \$3,124,843.60.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:27:54 Ron Orebaugh, Delaware County Soil and Water Conservation District:**

- Provided updates on the district's annual meeting, which drew 65 attendees. Noted award recipients: Larry Shrews (Conservation Farmer of the Year) and Ball State Natural Resources (Conservation Partner of the Year).
- Distributed county plat books (available at the extension office for \$25) featuring aerial, infrared, and soil maps.
- Addressed erosion and soil loss issues at the county farm/highway property on the north side, noting that severe soil runoff is clogging ditches. Offered assistance from the Soil and Water Conservation District and retired board member Dan to walk the property and help plan conservation fixes (such as waterways and tiling) as a fall project.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Public hearings for tax sale certificate assignments to nonprofits are scheduled for April 3, 2017, and April 17, 2017. EMS billing contract negotiations are ongoing.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following the public comment period and final procedural motions.

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